

Polishing Your Routine for Competition

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"The cleaner routine will win!"

I. "The eye"

- a. Do you have it?
 - i. It is the people who have the ability to see the incorrect things in a routine & be able to fix them
 - 1. From the biggest things -> to the smallest things
- b. The judges are not looking for teams that can just throw any skill on the mat....they are looking for HOW WELL each team PERFORMS and EXECUTES the skills in their routine.

II. Where to start?

- a. This is a good time to be OCD!
- b. Pay attention to the little things of the routine.
 - i. The Basics
 - 1. Technique/form
 - a. Where are their hands? Where are their feet?
 - b. EVERYONE needs to look the same.
 - c. Placement
 - i. Arms, head, hands, legs, feet.
 - d. Timing
 - 2. Execution
 - a. How do you teach the routine?
 - i. Teach the details and perfect before you move on.
 - ii. Teach how to perform each part.
 - 3. Quality
 - a. Not only is it important in your score, but it will only help your business.
 - b. The kids on that mat are your biggest marketing tool.

III. Transitions can make or break the routine

- a. The smoother the better.
 - i. Spend an adequate amount of time of transitions
 - ii. Crossing middle rule
 - iii. Be efficient
 - 1. Make then as short as possible
 - 2. A transition longer then 1 8-count is too long
 - 3. If a transition is more than 4-counts incorporate elements (i.e., tumbling, motions, stunts, etc.)
 - iv. Keep them clean
 - 1. Arms should always stay tight and by side when not doing anything

2. Drill proper posture (shoulders back, chest up, head held high)
3. Avoid turning backs toward the judges
4. Fix any traffic congestion
5. Work backwards if it helps

b. Be creative

- i. You don't always have to "walk" as a transition
- ii. Don't be afraid to try something new; think outside the box

IV. Structure your practices to incorporate cleaning

- a. Break those bad habits.
 - i. Take time to re-teach or re-work bad habits you might inherit
 - ii. Be sure to break the details down while you teach
 - b. Teach your kids the importance of accepting critiques & criticism
 - i. It's all about the TEAM, not the individual
 - c. Make sure staff, parents, and kids all know that technique is just as important as the skill
 - d. Break the routine down into parts
 - i. Be picky!!
 1. Arm/foot placement
 2. How everyone moves from one thing to the next (i.e., which foot you step with, etc.)
 3. Body positions
 4. Facial expressions
 - a. Try to keep them the same across the board
 - e. Work in groups
 - i. Take turns with each group and have them comment each other
 1. Kids are their own worst critics
 - ii. Work by row
 - iii. Then right side, center, left side
 - iv. Work each individual stunt group (focus on counts and watch arms, legs, dismounts, etc.)
 - v. Individual jumps & tumbling, then group jumps and timed tumbling
 1. Focus on landings, execution, etc.
- V. Remember that cleanliness outscores difficulty.
- a. Don't choreograph things the kids cannot do!
 - b. Keep a more detail oriented mind. Learn to be OCD
 - c. Teach the kids to be detailed oriented
 - d. Just make sure it is easy on the eyes and pleasant to watch

VIDEO!